

I disagree that multilingualism should be provided in the university as the learning and reading tools. Reason why I disagree is because if the government implies this in the school, universities are going to be difficult for students and lecturers to communicate with each other. Having multiple languages in the classroom is going to be a hard process to teach and learn. It also going to lead to confusion and inconsistency in academic delivery. They may find it difficult to provide lectures with relevant resources and trained lecturers for different languages.

Multilingualism is an effective approach to teaching, learning, and assessment in countries with diverse languages. It helps to build knowledge, empowers students, and improves educational outcomes. In countries such as South Africa, where students speak multiple languages, relying on only one language in education is both limiting and unfair. Therefore, multilingualism should be adopted to create a more inclusive and effective education system.

Firstly, multilingualism enhances students' understanding of academic content. Learners are able to use all the languages they know to process information more effectively. Traditional approaches often assume that one language, usually English, is sufficient for learning. However, research shows that multilingual students benefit more when they are allowed to use their full linguistic repertoire through practices such as translanguaging (Mbirimi-Hungwe, 2023: 1). This approach allows students to interpret, discuss, and express ideas using familiar languages, leading to deeper comprehension. In this way, language becomes a resource rather than a barrier to learning.

Secondly, multilingualism promotes inclusion and supports students' confidence. When learners' home languages are excluded from the classroom, they may feel marginalised and less motivated to participate. Studies indicate that students who are taught in unfamiliar languages often struggle to engage and may become passive in the learning process (Viriri & Ndimande-Hlongwa, 2023: 7). In contrast, when multiple languages are recognised and used in teaching, students feel valued and included. This inclusive environment strengthens their confidence and encourages active participation, which is essential for academic success.

Furthermore, multilingualism improves educational outcomes, particularly in assessment. The use of English as the sole language of assessment can disadvantage students who are not fluent in it. They may struggle to understand questions or express their answers clearly, even when they understand the content. Research highlights that using indigenous languages in assessment can improve fairness and allow students to demonstrate their full potential (Viriri & Ndimande-Hlongwa, 2023: 1). Additionally, multilingual teaching strategies have been shown to improve literacy development and comprehension, as learners are able to connect new knowledge with their existing linguistic and cognitive resources (Carrim & Nkomo, 2023: 195).

In conclusion, multilingualism is a valuable and necessary approach in linguistically diverse countries. It enhances understanding, promotes inclusion, and improves academic performance. Education systems that rely on a single dominant language risk disadvantaging many learners. Therefore, adopting multilingual approaches in teaching, learning, and assessment is essential for creating a fair, inclusive, and effective education system.